

Texas WIC Health and Human Services Commission

Effective July 1, 2026

Policy No. CS:05.0

Identification of a WIC Applicant/Participant and Parent or Guardian

Purpose

To ensure program benefits are provided to the correct individual.

Authority

7 CFR Part 246.7; 26 TAC Section 366.3

Policy

The local agency (LA) staff must check the identification of each applicant/participant and parent/guardian/caretaker applying on behalf of an infant and/or child at each certification.

Definitions

Provisional Certification – a 30-day certification and up to 30-days benefit issuance for an applicant/participant who meets all eligibility criteria at certification but fails to bring one of the acceptable proofs of identification, residency or income.

Disaster Expedited Certification – a certification process where anthropometrics and blood work are optional but must be obtained within 90 days from certification during a disaster situation.

Procedures

- I. At each certification, LA staff must request and check the identification of each applicant and parent/guardian/caretaker.
 - A. Proof of identification must be verified and documented in the MIS.
 - B. A copy or electronic image of the original document is acceptable. Documents obtained via electronic transmission are automatically saved in the MIS and may be used for subsequent certification when the participant/parent/guardian verbally confirms the information is still current.

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- C. The following must be accepted as documentation of identity regardless of the expiration date or age of the document.
1. Baptismal certificate
 2. Birth certificate
 3. Driver's license
 4. Employee check stub with name printed on it
 5. Employee Identification Card with picture
 6. Foster placement letter
 7. Health care identification
 8. Hospital records
 9. Housing/rental agreement
 10. Immunization Card
 11. Immigration records
 12. Loan papers
 13. Local Agency clinic card
 14. Marriage license
 15. Military Identification card
 16. Medicaid letters/forms
 17. Official/Government Identification card with picture
 18. Passport
 19. Property tax receipt
 20. School Identification card with picture
 21. Self-Declaration Form
 22. Self-Declaration Disaster Form
 23. SNAP letters/forms

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24. Social Security Administration forms/letters
 25. Social Security card
 26. TANF letters/forms
 27. Texas WIC Card or Other States' WIC Identification Card
 28. Voter's registration card
 29. Your Texas Benefits Card (YTBC)
 30. Approved Local Agency Other – If an LA wants to use other forms of identity not listed above, the LA must develop a policy and submit it to the state agency (SA) for approval prior to implementation. The policy must be available for audit/review.
- II. Item Provisional Certification must be offered to an applicant/parent/guardian/caretaker who does not provide proof of identification at the time of the certification appointment but meets all other eligibility criteria and applicable documentation requirements.
- A. If the applicant/parent/guardian/caretaker meets all other eligibility requirements:
1. The MIS will allow up to 30-day benefit issuance.
 2. If the applicant/parent/guardian/caretaker returns with the correct proof within 30 days and is found eligible, the MIS will establish the full certification period.
 3. If the applicant does not return within 30 days with the correct proof, the applicant is ineligible, and the certification is automatically terminated by the MIS.
- B. Under no circumstances shall a second or subsequent Provisional Certification be applied if the applicant fails to provide the required documentation within the 30 days.
- III. Applicants or parents/guardians/caretakers who are victims of theft, loss, or homelessness must complete the WIC Self-Declaration Form for

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Identification, Residency, Zero-Income (Cash on Hand) and Proof of Income (Homeless) (stock # E13-06-13567). Staff must upload form into the MIS.

- IV. Current participants and applicants who qualify for Disaster Expedited Certification because they are victims of disaster must complete the electronic WIC Self-Declaration Form for Disaster Victims in the MIS (refer to the [*State of Texas WIC Program Disaster Plan*](#)).